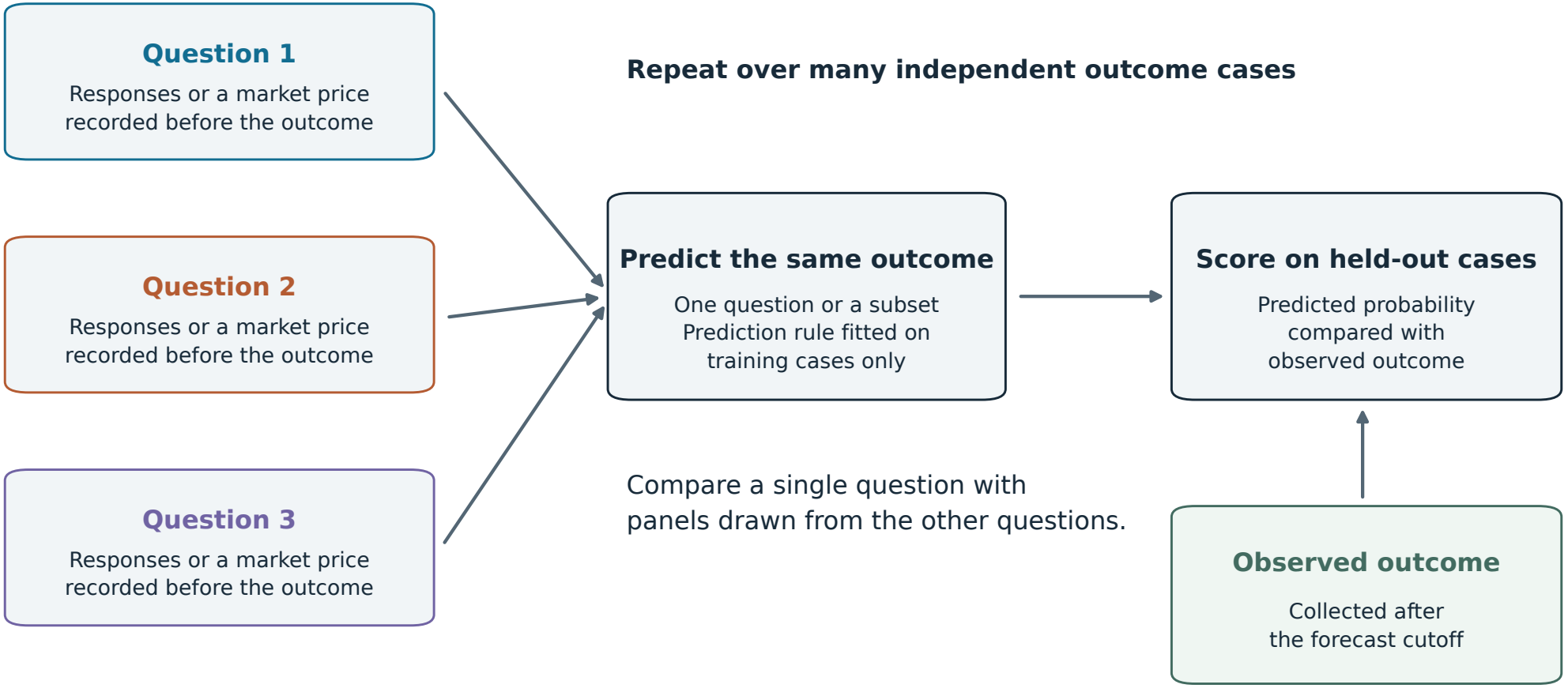
How predictive is a question?

Working interpretation: questions supply signals; a later observed outcome is the target.

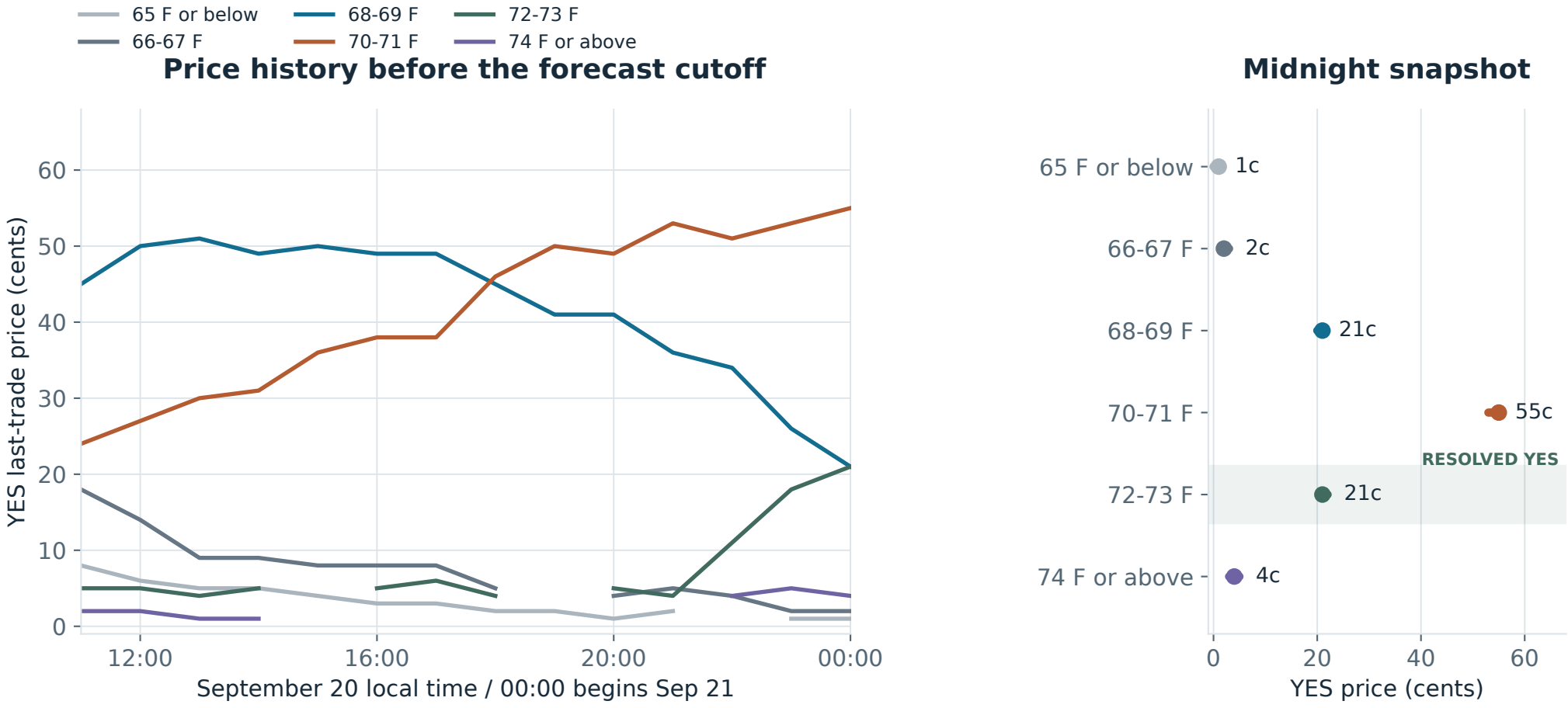


Equivalence asks: what reference-panel size matches the question's predictive score?

Provisional unit: one question. A market price aggregates traders; it is not one human rating.
Real data must define the outcome cases, forecast cutoff, question identities, and reference pool before scoring.

Kalshi: several questions, one observed outcome

NYC maximum temperature / September 21, 2026 / six related temperature-range contracts

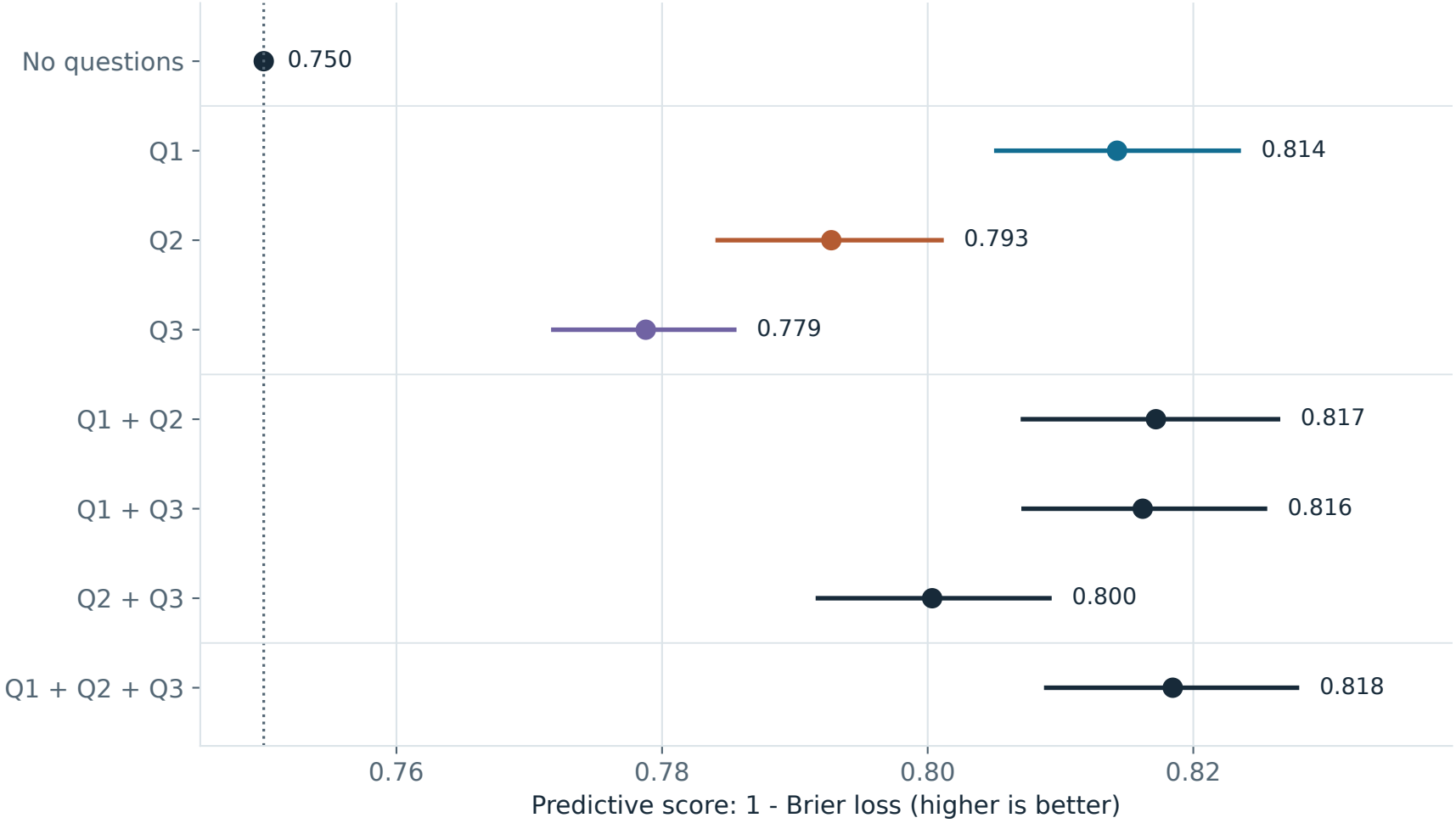


Recorded outcome: 72 F / the 72-73 F contract resolved YES

Raw hourly closing trade prices; snapshot at Sep 21, 00:00 America/New_York. Short bars show the closing bid/ask spread.
Snapshot YES prices total $1.04; no normalization. Mutually exclusive contracts are not independent forecasters.
Gaps indicate no reported trade close. Last-trade ages can differ even at a common candle boundary.
Source: public Kalshi API, KXHIGHNY-26SEP21; settlement source: The Weather Company. One event does not estimate equivalence.

Compare predictive performance on the same cases

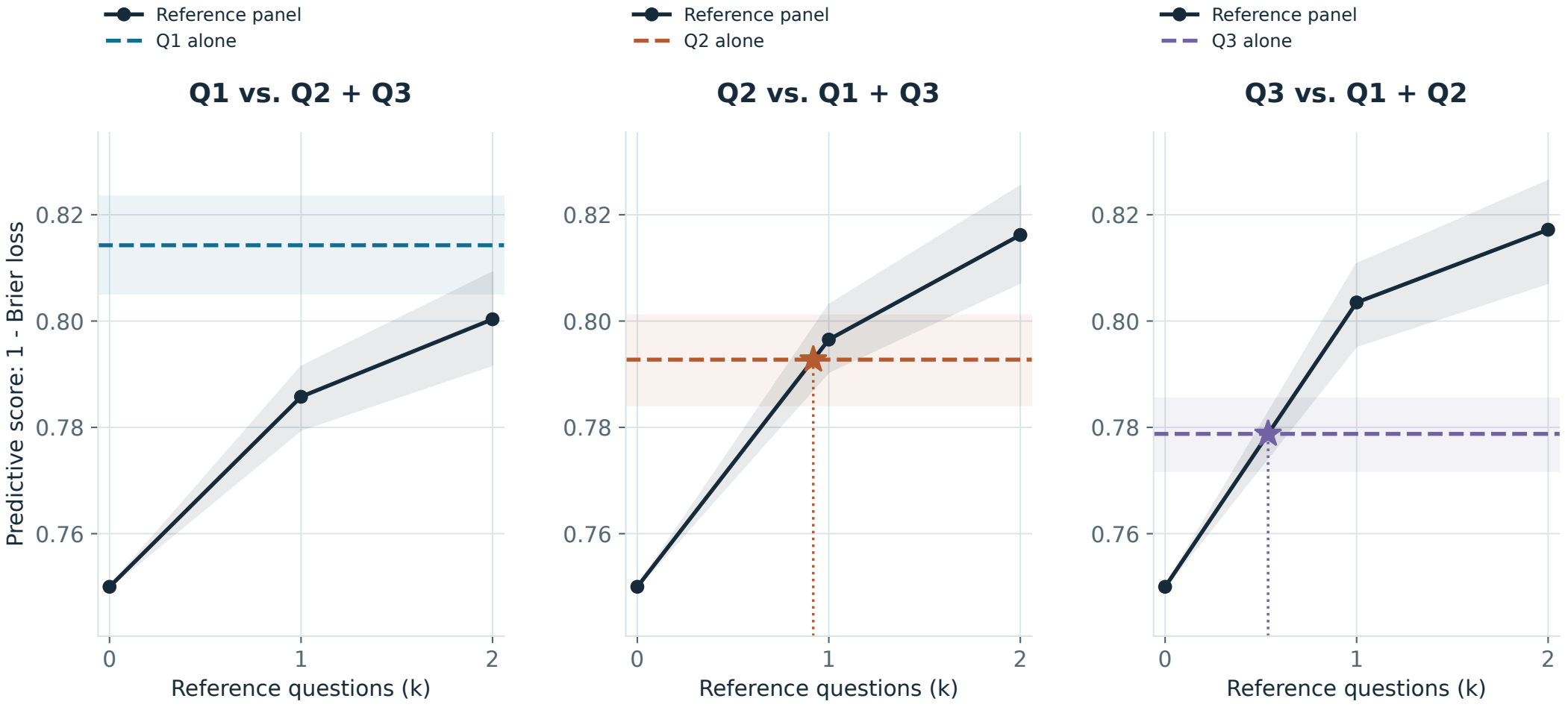
2,400 training cases / 1,600 held-out cases / a separately fitted predictor for every question subset



Dots: held-out scores. Lines: 95% paired test-case bootstrap intervals, conditional on fixed fitted models.
Zero questions uses the training outcome frequency. These synthetic differences describe the simulation only.
Panels use jointly fitted logistic predictors; no human-equivalence or information-equivalence claim is made.

Express each question in reference-panel units

Each benchmark excludes the question being evaluated. The reference pool changes between panels.



At k=1, average the scores of the two eligible single-question predictors; at k=2, use their joint predictor.
Fractional k is interpolation (a mixture of adjacent panel sizes), not a literal fraction of a question. No extrapolation.
Shading: conditional 95% score intervals, not equivalence intervals. Different reference pools do not give a common ranking.